X-CHANGE BANKING PROGRAM GUIDE

Government Depository Digital Banking Program Guide

A Canonical Implementation Guide for Philippine Government Depository Institutions

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BOARD BRIEFING

Executive Summary

Public money carries more than value. It carries lawful purpose, institutional authority, conditions, and a continuing obligation to account for what occurred. A public collection must be attributed correctly. A disbursement must proceed under valid authority. An unresolved outcome must remain visible. Completion must return evidence sufficient for reconciliation, review, and audit.

Government entities already use accounts, payment rails, electronic transfers, digital channels, and reporting systems. Eligible depository institutions already possess or establish the banking authority, regulated relationships, controls, and settlement arrangements required for their work. The institutional question is whether those foundations can support a wider range of governed public-finance services without constructing a separate operating model for every program.

Connectivity alone does not answer that question. A rail may move funds and an API may carry an instruction. Neither establishes public purpose, confirms authority, recognizes and reserves resources, applies conditions, manages exceptions, preserves evidence, or reconciles the completed obligation. Those remain responsibilities of the government entity and the depository institution.

The **Program** is the institutional initiative through which an eligible government depository institution establishes one reusable governed operating foundation for selected public-finance workflows. The enduring result is the **Capability**: the maintained ability to turn properly authorized public-finance instructions into observable, executable, evidentiary, and reconcilable banking activity.

Public money remains the protagonist. The government entity retains its public purpose, program authority, approvals, participant basis, and accountability. The depository institution retains banking authority, custody, accounts, policies, infrastructure, credentials, production control, settlement relationships, and institutional readiness. x-change supplies the operating grammar beneath those arrangements. `emi-core` supplies the common execution contract, and a maintained institution-specific driver—represented as `3neti/emi-{institution}`—maps that contract to the institution's approved API behavior.

The government entity brings lawful purpose and instruction. The depository institution brings banking authority and the approved rails. x-change brings the operating grammar. The institution-specific driver connects them.

The driver is institution-specific engineering, not an automatically available connector. It requires discovery, API mapping, implementation, certification, and continuing maintenance. Certification establishes technical behavior under tested conditions. It does not establish operational readiness. Readiness remains an institutional judgment based on the complete public-finance ceremony.

An LGU assistance disbursement makes the model visible. The responsible public entity establishes the program authority, approved recipient basis, funding, conditions, and expected evidence. The depository institution recognizes the supporting resources, applies banking controls, reserves the required capacity, defines the service, issues or supports the approved credential, coordinates execution through its settlement arrangement, records the result, manages exceptions, and reconciles the completed activity.

The public institution authorized an outcome. The depository institution arranged its accountable execution.

The same Capability supports government payroll, pensions and veterans' benefits, scholarships, agricultural support, disaster assistance, public collections, treasury operations, GOCC activity, procurement settlement, and other workflows approved by the responsible institutions. Their authority, participants, conditions, evidence, and public purpose differ. The operating grammar remains stable.

The institutional case rests on capability, not entitlement. A qualified institution with credible authority, operating discipline, and reusable capability gains a stronger basis for selected public-finance responsibilities. Deposits, selection, and preferred status still depend on lawful process, qualification, price, service, evidence, and performance.

The Program begins with one bounded ceremony. The responsible institutions establish authority and suitability, define the service, complete institution-specific integration, test the complete operation, prepare personnel, and determine whether evidence supports controlled production. Expansion follows only when the institution is prepared to carry the next responsibility.

The decision before the Board is whether the institution should establish one reusable governed operating Capability for selected public-finance services and authorize Management to define the first ceremony, complete the required institutional work, and return with evidence sufficient for a controlled production decision.

SECTION 1

Why This Program?

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

Why should our institution establish this Program?

KEY MESSAGE

Public-finance participation requires more than authority and settlement access. The opportunity is to organize them through one governed operating foundation that strengthens accountability and supports more public-finance services over time.

EXECUTIVE DECISION

I understand the institutional problem and can decide whether establishing a reusable governed operating Capability merits formal evaluation.

Government depository institutions support arrangements through which public authority becomes collection, payroll, assistance, benefit, procurement, treasury, or other accountable financial activity. Their responsibility extends beyond moving funds to preserving the authority, conditions, and evidence attached to public money.

Many eligible institutions already operate core banking systems, digital channels, settlement accounts, payment integrations, cybersecurity controls, and professional operating organizations. Government entities likewise maintain program rules, appropriations or funding authorities, approval structures, participant records, accounting practices, and audit obligations. Yet each new workflow may still require a different arrangement for financial state, approvals, provider integration, conditions, exceptions, evidence, and reconciliation.

That repeated construction can limit institutional choice. An institution may possess relevant authority yet remain difficult to consider for a demanding workflow because the complete service requires more than an account and a payment connection. Government must be able to identify authority, responsibility, satisfied conditions, completed activity, unresolved outcomes, and the evidence returned to the public record.

The Program addresses that operating problem by organizing capabilities the participating institutions already possess or separately establish through approved authority and relationships. It does not confer government-depository authority, program eligibility, procurement preference, settlement access, or public trust.

The timing is practical. Maintained software, institution-controlled cloud environments, API-based integration, automated testing, observability, and regulated payment infrastructure now allow an institution to establish a reusable foundation without rebuilding the same orchestration machinery for every public program.

Public trust depends on accountable execution. The institution therefore needs infrastructure that preserves responsibility and evidence from instruction through reconciliation.

One foundation will not make public programs alike. It will give the institution a consistent way to govern their differences.

SECTION 2

What Is the Program?

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

What exactly is the institution being invited to establish?

KEY MESSAGE

The Program is an institution-specific modernization initiative. Its result is a maintained operating Capability through which selected public-finance services can be governed under the authority of the responsible institutions.

EXECUTIVE DECISION

I understand the Program, the Capability it is intended to establish, the participating roles, and the boundaries that remain subject to public and institutional approval.

The Government Depository Digital Banking Program brings together licensed x-change software, institution-specific integration, controlled deployment, testing, observability, documentation, maintenance, public-program governance, and banking operating discipline. The resulting Capability coordinates the progression from lawful purpose and recognized resources to conditions, credential, execution, evidence, and reconciliation.

The Program is the initiative. The Capability is the enduring operational result. The Program can be authorized, governed, implemented, and reviewed. The Capability is what the institution continues to operate, maintain, and apply to approved services.

The participating depository institution is the banking sponsor and production authority. Its Board and Management establish institutional purpose, risk appetite, scope, accountability, and approval boundaries. Operations, Treasury, Technology, Risk, Compliance, Legal, Information Security, Internal Audit, Finance, and other responsible functions perform their established roles.

The government entity remains responsible for the public program within its authority. It defines or administers the public purpose, participant basis, funding authority, approvals, program conditions, reporting, and public accountability applicable to the service. The Program does not transfer those duties to the depository institution or to a technology provider.

Open Disbursement Technologies, Inc. (ODTI) licenses and maintains x-change, `emi-core`, supported components, documentation, reference architecture, testing capability, and agreed institution-specific driver work. ODTI does not become the government entity, depository institution, custodian, settlement provider, auditor, or production authority.

A DevOps or managed-service provider may perform delegated provisioning, deployment, monitoring, backup, recovery, release support, and incident-response work. It acts within the institution's approved environment and delegated authority. It does not own the environment, data, credentials, provider accounts, billing relationships, or release decision.

The settlement institution or payment provider performs supported financial movement under its approved relationship with the depository institution. No exclusive settlement provider is prescribed. The depository institution owns or establishes the applicable account, participation, credentials, limits, and execution authority.

Licensing and participation remain institution-specific. Agreements must distinguish the software license, implementation, driver engineering, maintenance, managed operations, support, public-program responsibilities, and regulated-provider services. None should be confused with government authority, banking authority, custody, or production approval.

Governance follows responsibility. Public authority remains public. Banking responsibility remains with the depository institution. Providers supply only the capabilities assigned to them. Production begins only through the required institutional approvals.

The Program should be judged by whether it establishes accountable institutional capability—not by the amount of software deployed. The complete participant and authority model appears in the supporting Stakeholder Architecture and Responsibility Matrix.

SECTION 3

Why Should the Institution Proceed?

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

What does the institution gain by proceeding?

KEY MESSAGE

The institution gains a reusable governed foundation through which it can support selected public-finance workflows while preserving its authority, deployment, data, settlement relationships, and institutional accountability.

EXECUTIVE DECISION

I understand the prospective institutional benefit and can decide whether it warrants commercial, authority, and implementation evaluation.

The principal benefit is operating leverage. A maintained grammar for authority, financial state, conditions, credentials, execution, and evidence reduces the foundational work repeated for each public-finance service. The institution must still examine authority, suitability, policy, risk, procurement or engagement, integration, operations, participant treatment, accounting, and support. What changes is the starting point.

Branches, government portals, agency systems, corporate channels, mobile experiences, field operations, and partner APIs remain useful points of initiation, presentation, and reporting. x-change coordinates the governed ceremony beneath them. The institution can improve a participant experience without creating a separate financial-state or settlement model.

Operating sovereignty remains intact. The institution owns or controls its approved environment, deployment, data, domains, credentials, provider accounts, monitoring, backups, security configuration, releases, and audit trail. It retains its direct government, customer, depositor, and settlement relationships.

The same foundation supports services with different public purposes. Assistance programs connect authorized funding with approved recipients. Payroll connects public employers with personnel. Pension and benefit services connect continuing authority with recurring obligations. Collections connect government services with payer attribution and public accounting. Procurement settlement connects approved obligations with documentary evidence and supplier outcomes.

Their value depends on actual authority, institutional fit, service design, lawful process, commercial terms, implementation, and sustained performance. Qualification, selection, deposits, transaction volume, and revenue remain contingent on those conditions.

The credible benefit is the ability to evaluate and govern more demanding services without reconstructing the operating foundation each time. Management and technical attention can focus on public purpose, institutional responsibility, control quality, participant experience, evidence, and chosen areas of public-finance participation.

A capable institution is better positioned to become a stronger or preferred institutional option for selected workflows. Preference remains earned.

The institution modernizes without surrendering its identity or public responsibility.

SECTION 4

How Does the Program Work?

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

How does the operating model work?

KEY MESSAGE

Public authority remains with the government entity, and custody and banking authority remain with the depository institution. x-change coordinates the governed ceremony, while the institution-specific driver connects it to approved execution and settlement capability.

EXECUTIVE DECISION

I understand where public authority, funds, software, integration, execution, evidence, reconciliation, and institutional readiness reside.

The institutional stack is:

```
Government Program and Authorized Instruction
                    ↓
        Depository Banking Service
                    ↓
  Institution-Controlled x-change Deployment
                    ↓
              emi-core
                    ↓
       3neti/emi-{institution}
                    ↓
    Institution API and Settlement Account
                    ↓
        Approved Settlement Arrangement
```

The government program establishes lawful purpose, authority, participant basis, and public obligations. The depository banking service expresses the institution's approved role, policies, controls, terms, and responsibility. x-change coordinates the governed ceremony. `emi-core` defines the common execution contract. `3neti/emi-{institution}` translates that contract into approved API behavior. Accounts, credentials, and settlement arrangements remain under institutional authority.

The operating grammar keeps different responsibilities from being mistaken for one another.

A **Funding Event** records the external financial event through which Settlement Resources enter or become recognized by Treasury. It records institutional recognition; it does not create public money or determine its legal or accounting character.

Treasury maintains the operational state of Settlement Resources supporting the approved activity. A **Lien** reserves capacity for an authorized purpose while an instruction remains outstanding. Neither transfers custody.

A **Facility** gives the public-finance service its purpose, participants, policies, limits, commercial treatment, and institutional responsibility. The governing public program remains the source of public authority.

A **Settlement Envelope** carries the evidence and conditions that must be satisfied before an instruction may proceed. Approvals, identity, recipient basis, documents, limits, signatures, program references, and other institution-defined requirements belong here.

A **Pay Code** represents an authorized instruction in a form that can be communicated, presented, validated, and executed. It is a credential—not money, a public fund, a benefit, a deposit, stored value, or the banking service itself. A printed or digital voucher may carry or resolve to that credential; it does not create a separate voucher balance or execution model.

Execution coordinates the progression from authorized instruction to the outcome defined by the Facility. The execution engine and institution-specific driver address the institution's approved API. Institutional and provider references, status, exceptions, and evidence return to the operating record for reconciliation.

The driver is necessary because institutional APIs differ. Discovery and mapping must address authentication, certificates, signatures, request formats, idempotency, webhooks, statuses, limits, errors, reversals, reconciliation evidence, and versions. ODTI and an appointed engineering provider may implement and maintain the driver within scope. The institution governs credentials, review, certification, release, and change.

Deployment remains under institutional control. Each institution retains its own environment, data, credentials, monitoring, backups, release approvals, provider accounts, and audit trail. A DevOps or managed-service provider may administer delegated functions within that boundary. Common software and delegated operation do not create shared tenancy or transfer production authority.

x-change does not take custody. Public funds remain within the applicable government and regulated banking arrangements. Treasury supplies an operational view; it does not replace the bank account, government accounting record, appropriation, trust, or general ledger.

Technical completion is narrower than readiness. A certified driver demonstrates agreed API behavior under tested conditions. The responsible institutions must still decide whether the complete service can be lawfully authorized, operated, supervised, secured, settled, reconciled, supported, audited, and governed.

Canonical definitions appear in the Glossary. Further detail appears in Treasury Grammar, Deployment Architecture, and the supporting Program Architecture.

SECTION 5

Banking in Action

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

Show me how the Capability works in practice.

KEY MESSAGE

One operating grammar can support different public-finance services because their purposes and conditions may change while authority, financial state, execution, evidence, and reconciliation remain consistently governed.

EXECUTIVE DECISION

I can recognize how the operating model applies to a representative public-finance ceremony and how the same foundation can support other institution-approved workflows.

An LGU assistance disbursement makes the complete operating discipline visible within one familiar public obligation.

The responsible LGU establishes the program, lawful authority, approved funding, recipient basis, release conditions, accountable officials, and required evidence. The depository institution confirms the banking arrangement, receives or recognizes the supporting funds, applies policy, and defines how approved recipients may receive the service.

Treasury recognizes the supporting Settlement Resources. A Lien reserves the required amount. The assistance Facility defines participants, limits, service responsibility, and approved commercial treatment. The Settlement Envelope carries recipient evidence, approvals, conditions, references, and other requirements. Once authorized, a Pay Code or approved presentation carries the instruction through the defined journey.

The recipient presents the approved credential and satisfies the conditions. Execution coordinates the instruction through the depository institution's approved relationship. The institution-specific driver translates the common execution contract into approved API behavior. The financial movement occurs within the regulated arrangement. x-change records the result, updates operational state, resolves the Lien, preserves evidence, and supports reconciliation, exception handling, and public-program reporting.

The public institution authorized an outcome. The depository institution arranged its accountable execution.

The same grammar applies elsewhere:

Public-finance service	What changes	What remains governed
Government payroll	Employer authority, personnel attribution, timing, scale, release	Funding, reservation, conditions, execution, evidence, reconciliation
Pensions, veterans' benefits, and other benefits	Entitlement basis, continuing eligibility, recipient access, recurrence	Purpose, identity, conditions, unresolved outcomes, evidence
Government collections	Direction of value, payer reference, obligation, account mapping	Recognition, attribution, status, exceptions, reconciliation
Scholarships and agricultural support	Eligibility, cohort or season, milestones, permitted use	Authority, funding, conditions, instruction, outcome evidence
Disaster assistance	Urgency, geography, recipient basis, channel availability	Approval, reservation, execution, exceptions, continuing accountability
Treasury operations	Funding recognition, accounts, liquidity, release scheduling, provider positions	Operational state, reservations, execution, evidence, reconciliation
GOCC and procurement settlement	Contract or operating authority, acceptance evidence, suppliers, timing	Purpose, segregation, conditions, execution, records, reconciliation

LGU assistance need not be the first production service. The institution should begin with the ceremony that best combines public importance, established authority, bounded scope, operating familiarity, and readiness to learn.

One ceremony makes the grammar visible. Many governed services make the Capability institutionally useful. The supporting Government Workflow Taxonomy provides the complete cross-workflow reference.

SECTION 6

The Institutional Case

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

What kind of institution can the Program help the depository institution become?

KEY MESSAGE

The Capability can strengthen public-finance participation, evidentiary discipline, institutional choice, and adaptability while economic value remains dependent on lawful selection and dependable operation.

EXECUTIVE DECISION

I understand the institutional and commercial case and can decide whether it merits detailed evaluation under the institution's authority, strategy, risk appetite, and financial governance.

Government-depository authority alone does not establish a central role in demanding public-finance activity. Holding accounts does not establish the operating ceremony through which a public program is funded, conditioned, executed, evidenced, and reconciled.

Governed workflows create the basis for a broader institutional role. Collections can connect a depository institution to recurring local or agency activity. Payroll can create continuing account and service relationships. Pension and benefit administration can establish durable responsibilities. Assistance programs can demonstrate reach and evidentiary discipline. Treasury and procurement workflows can deepen the institution's participation in accountable public administration.

Where the actual program structure supports them, those relationships may contribute deposits and recurring activity. They may also strengthen institutional relevance, service income, operating knowledge, and the ability to compete for appropriate future work.

The stronger proposition is capability. By relating authority, funds, conditions, execution, exceptions, evidence, and reconciliation, a trusted institution establishes a more credible position for selected public-finance responsibilities. Institutional identity, mandate, constituency, geography, service design, financial standing, controls, price, and performance remain part of any lawful selection.

The Capability also supports adaptability. Resilience allows an institution to continue through difficulty; adaptability allows it to evaluate new responsibilities through an established foundation. The institution cannot predict every public-finance requirement of the next decade. It can preserve the ability to respond without rebuilding its operating model for each program.

The commercial case remains disciplined. Costs may include licensing, institution-specific implementation, driver engineering and maintenance, institution-controlled infrastructure, managed operations, internal governance and operations, settlement-provider charges, security, support, reconciliation, and continuing assurance. Sources of economic value include approved service income, deposits associated with actual program structures, recurring activity, reduced duplicated engineering, stronger government relationships, and broader institutional relevance. None is automatic.

The Commercial Waterfall makes responsibility visible without inventing prices: the approved public-finance service enters the institution's commercial and operating model; government, provider, and internal obligations are recognized; license, implementation, driver, infrastructure, operations, settlement, support, and maintenance responsibilities are allocated; the institution evaluates the residual financial and public value.

Commercial sustainability exists when the arrangement funds dependable operation and preserves clear accountability for who authorizes, performs, earns, pays, bears risk, and remains answerable for the public outcome.

The Board is deciding more than whether to acquire software. It is deciding whether the institution should establish a reusable Capability through which public authority and banking responsibility can support more accountable public-finance services over time.

SECTION 7

Launching the Program

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

What happens after approval?

KEY MESSAGE

Approval begins a controlled institutional journey from authority and suitability assessment to one bounded production ceremony. It does not place the institution or a public program into production.

EXECUTIVE DECISION

I understand the sequence, evidence, governance gates, and next decision required to begin controlled implementation.

Board approval establishes institutional purpose, scope, accountability, and authority for Management to proceed. It does not approve a government program, confer depository eligibility, complete procurement, or authorize production. Management names accountable leaders and confirms how Operations, Treasury, Technology, Risk, Compliance, Security, Legal, Finance, Audit, public-program counterparts, and providers will participate.

Implementation begins by understanding the institution and the proposed public responsibility. The parties establish applicable authority, public purpose, source and character of funds, participants, approvals, policies, and conditions. They also identify channels, systems, accounts, accounting, evidence, reconciliation, support, exceptions, continuity, settlement arrangements, and accountable owners. Unknowns remain visible until resolved by responsible authorities.

The institution then defines the first public-finance ceremony. The participant experience is part of the banking service, not a separate design exercise. The ceremony identifies what the public entity authorizes, what the depository institution agrees to do, what evidence is required, how participants are informed, how exceptions are handled, and what completion means.

Driver discovery proceeds in parallel. ODTI, the institution, and any appointed engineering provider examine approved API behavior, authentication, certificates, request and response structures, references, idempotency, webhooks, status, limits, exceptions, reversals, reconciliation evidence, test environments, and change processes. They map the behavior to `emi-core`, implement it in `3neti/emi-{institution}`, test it, and certify it.

Certification is a technical gate. Operational readiness is a separate institutional gate. Responsible personnel validate the public instruction, approvals, Funding Events, Treasury state, Liens, Facility rules, Settlement Envelope conditions, Pay Code presentation, execution, provider behavior, accounting, evidence, support, reconciliation, records, and audit as one operation. They also test delay, failure, duplication, reversal, and uncertain outcomes.

Readiness is an institutional judgment. It exists when the responsible institutions have sufficient evidence that the ceremony can be lawfully authorized, operated, supervised, secured, settled, reconciled, supported, evidenced, audited, and governed.

Controlled production should be deliberately narrow. The institutions may limit participants, locations, agencies, values, channels, operating windows, Funding Events, or duration. Success measures are agreed before the pilot and may address correct authority, recipient or payer attribution, execution outcomes, reconciliation completeness and timeliness, exception resolution, service availability, participant evidence, support performance, security, and control effectiveness. Volume alone is not evidence of readiness.

The responsible institutions review the evidence and decide whether to **Proceed**, **Correct**, **Extend**, or **Pause**.

Expansion is phased, not automatic. An institution may extend the same Facility, introduce another channel, add a participant group, increase approved limits, support another public entity, or define a new ceremony. Each step repeats the disciplines of authority, suitability, conditions, readiness, controlled operation, and evidence.

The first approval authorizes institutional learning. Each later approval determines whether the responsible institutions are prepared to carry a larger public responsibility. The supporting Institution Intelligence Research Gate and Institution Readiness references govern those later transitions.

APPENDIX A

Glossary

These definitions apply to the Government Depository Digital Banking Program Guide and remain subordinate to applicable authority and the canonical x-change and Treasury grammar.

Capability — The enduring, maintained operating foundation established through the Program. It allows an eligible depository institution to turn properly authorized public-finance instructions into governed banking activity.

Program — The institution-specific initiative through which a government depository institution evaluates, establishes, governs, and introduces the Capability for selected public-finance services.

Public-finance ceremony — The complete progression from lawful public purpose and authorized instruction through funding recognition, banking policy, conditions, execution, evidence, exception handling, and reconciliation.

Government entity — The public institution acting within its applicable authority for the program, collection, disbursement, payroll, benefit, procurement, treasury, or other public responsibility. The term is descriptive, not a legal classification.

Government depository institution — A banking institution eligible under applicable authority to perform the relevant government-depository or public-finance responsibility. Eligibility for one class of activity does not establish qualification or selection for every workflow.

Funding Event — The record of an external financial event through which Settlement Resources enter or become recognized by Treasury. It records recognition; it does not create public money or determine its legal or accounting character.

Treasury — The operational view of Settlement Resources supporting approved activity, including what is recognized, reserved, available, outstanding, or unresolved. It is not the government account, bank account, appropriation record, trust record, or general ledger.

Settlement Resources — Resources recognized by Treasury as supporting an activity. Their custody, ownership, public character, and accounting treatment remain within applicable government and regulated banking arrangements.

Lien — An operational reservation of Settlement Resources for an authorized purpose while an instruction remains outstanding. It does not transfer custody.

Facility — The governed definition of a banking service. It carries purpose, participants, policies, commercial treatment, limits, and institutional responsibility. It does not replace the governing public authority or program.

Settlement Envelope — The evidence and conditions that must be satisfied before an instruction may proceed.

Pay Code — A credential representing an authorized instruction in a form that can be communicated, presented, validated, and executed. It is not money, a public fund, a benefit, a deposit, stored value, or the banking service.

Voucher-mediated journey — A printed or digital presentation that carries or resolves to an approved credential or instruction. It does not create a separate voucher balance, Treasury, or execution model.

Execution — The coordination of an authorized instruction toward the outcome defined by the Facility through the institution's approved execution capability.

Execution Engine — The component that coordinates the supported execution progression and invokes the applicable driver.

`emi-core` — The maintained common contract through which the operating grammar addresses institution-specific execution capability.

Driver / `3neti/emi-{institution}` — The maintained institution-specific implementation of `emi-core` for the institution's approved API, authentication, status, webhook, security, exception, and reconciliation behavior.

Evidence — Records sufficient for the responsible institutions to understand authority, instruction, conditions, execution, status, exception, and outcome according to their approved requirements. Platform evidence does not replace accounting or audit judgment.

Reconciliation — The institutional process through which operating state is compared with government, bank, and provider records and differences are investigated and resolved under approved procedures.

Readiness — The judgment of the responsible institutions that sufficient evidence exists to lawfully authorize, operate, supervise, secure, settle, reconcile, support, evidence, audit, and govern a ceremony.

Certification — Evidence that the institution-specific driver performs agreed technical behavior under tested conditions. Certification is not operational readiness.

Operating sovereignty — The institution's continuing control over its authority, relationships, policies, infrastructure, data, credentials, production decisions, settlement relationships, and audit trail.

Preferred institutional option — A position an eligible institution may seek within selected public-finance activities because its authority, fit, service, price, controls, capability, and performance present a credible choice. Technology does not confer the position, and no preference is guaranteed.

APPENDIX B

Governance

Governance follows public and institutional responsibility. No provider approval substitutes for the approval of the responsible government entity or depository institution.

Participant	Principal responsibility	Boundary
Board of Directors	Approves institutional purpose, risk appetite, scope, accountability, and material progression	Board approval begins the Program; it does not confer public authority or establish production readiness
President / CEO / Management	Owns Program sponsorship, resources, accountability, and management decisions	Does not treat Program authorization as government-program approval
Government entity / authorized officials	Establish or administer public purpose, authority, funding basis, participants, conditions, approvals, reporting, and public accountability	Do not transfer public authority to the bank or a technology provider
Business / public-sector banking	Defines the depository banking service, institutional responsibility, relationship model, terms, and economic case	Does not assign public authority or commercial meaning to a credential
Operations	Defines supervision, participant support, escalation, exception handling, evidence, and reconciliation practice	Does not rely on technical completion as an operating decision
Treasury	Governs operational financial state, reservations, liquidity, provider positions, and unresolved obligations	x-change Treasury does not replace accounts or determine legal fund character
Technology	Governs architecture, integration, environments, identity, observability, resilience, service management, and release	External engineering extends rather than displaces institutional capability
Risk and Compliance	Reviews risks, controls, obligations, monitoring, financial-crime controls, and participant treatment within authority	Does not transfer accountability to certification artifacts
Legal	Reviews authority, agreements, procurement or engagement, data treatment, terms, and legal characterization	The Guide is not a legal agreement or opinion
Information Security and Privacy	Govern access, credentials, certificates, testing, monitoring, incident response, data, and change	Production secrets and regulated data remain under approved institutional control
Finance / Accounting	Define accounting, financial reporting, provider-charge treatment, reconciliation, and records requirements	Platform state does not determine public accounting treatment
Internal Audit	Provides independent assurance according to its mandate	Does not become an implementation owner
External auditor / regulator / oversight body	Performs review, supervision, or assurance within applicable authority	Independent judgment is not replaced by platform evidence
ODTI	Licenses and maintains x-change, `emi-core`, supported components, documentation, testing capability, and agreed driver work	Does not provide public or banking authority, custody, settlement access, or production approval
3neti / appointed engineering provider	Performs institution-specific discovery, mapping, driver implementation, testing, and maintenance where engaged	Does not own the institution's API authority, credentials, data, or production decision
DevOps / managed-service provider	Performs delegated provisioning, deployment, monitoring, backup, recovery, release support, and incident work	Does not own the environment, data, credentials, billing, or release authority
Settlement institution / payment provider	Performs supported financial movement and provides records under its agreement	Does not define the public program or complete banking ceremony

Decision Gates

1. **Program authorization** — The Board or delegated authority permits Management to evaluate and establish the Program.
2. **Authority and suitability** — Responsible public and banking functions determine whether the candidate workflow may proceed to design.
3. **Service definition** — The institutions approve the first public-finance ceremony and accountable owners.
4. **Architecture, data, and security approval** — Responsible functions approve the intended environment, information flows, and integration boundary.
5. **Driver certification** — Agreed technical behavior is evidenced under controlled conditions.
6. **Operational readiness** — The responsible institutions judge the complete ceremony ready for bounded production.
7. **Pilot decision** — The required authorities approve a limited production scope.
8. **Evidence review** — The institutions decide to Proceed, Correct, Extend, or Pause.

Institution-specific legal, fiduciary, regulatory, procurement, banking, accounting, and audit responsibilities remain subject to the applicable authority and workflow. This appendix establishes the Program boundary; it does not allocate those responsibilities by itself.

The supporting Stakeholder Architecture and Responsibility Matrix provide the expanded sector-level reference.

APPENDIX C

Commercial Waterfall

The Commercial Waterfall explains how an approved public-finance service relates to the responsibilities required to operate it. Its purpose is to make those responsibilities visible before the participating institutions evaluate financial and public value.

It is a conceptual accountability model. It does not prescribe prices, revenue shares, public fees, procurement treatment, accounting treatment, taxes, or contractual terms.

Economic Sequence

1. The responsible public and banking institutions define the authorized public-finance service and the depository institution's approved commercial treatment.
2. Service activity creates the applicable fee, income, cost, deposit, liquidity, relationship, or public value within the actual program and banking model.
3. Settlement-provider, network, cloud, identity, communications, and other third-party charges are recognized under applicable agreements.
4. Licensed software, implementation, institution-specific driver, maintenance, managed operations, infrastructure, support, security, reconciliation, and internal operating responsibilities are allocated to the responsible parties.
5. The depository institution evaluates residual financial and institutional value against its authority, strategy, risk appetite, service obligations, and approved financial case.
6. The responsible government entity evaluates price, service, evidence, accountability, and public value under its applicable authority and process.

Cost and Responsibility Categories

Category	What it covers	Governing instrument
Software license	Right to use and receive maintained x-change software within agreed scope	License agreement
Implementation	Institution and workflow discovery, configuration, integration, validation, and launch work	Statement of work or implementation agreement
Institution-specific driver	Discovery, mapping, implementation, certification, and agreed evolution of `3neti/emi-{institution}`	Driver scope and maintenance terms
Maintenance	Supported releases, compatibility, fixes, documentation, and agreed platform evolution	Maintenance terms
Managed operations	Delegated deployment and operating services	Managed-service agreement and institutional controls
Institution infrastructure	Cloud or approved hosting, domains, monitoring, security, backups, and related provider services	Institution-controlled provider agreements
Settlement and payment services	Account, participation, transaction, network, sponsor, foreign-exchange, and provider charges	Institution's settlement and provider agreements
Public-program administration	Authority, participant administration, communications, program operations, accounting, records, and public reporting	Applicable public authority, budget, process, and agreement
Internal institutional work	Governance, public-sector banking, Operations, Treasury, Technology, Risk, Compliance, Security, Finance, Audit, and support	Institution budgets and mandates

Deposits and transaction activity arise only from actual public-finance relationships. Software licensing does not guarantee them.

No commercial flow changes custody, public authority, banking responsibility, settlement responsibility, or production control. Detailed amounts require separate evidence, negotiation, due diligence, and approval.

APPENDIX D

Treasury Grammar

Treasury gives the institution a consistent operational view of financial state across a governed public-finance ceremony. The grammar distinguishes recognized resources, reservations, service meaning, conditions, execution, and reconciliation without changing the authority or custody beneath them.

Canonical Progression

```
                                External financial event
                                          ↓
                                     Funding Event
                                          ↓
                          Settlement Resources recognized by Treasury
                                          ↓
                        Lien reserves resources for an authorized purpose
                                          ↓
      Facility gives the activity banking, public-service, and approved commercial meaning
                                          ↓
                    Settlement Envelope establishes evidence and conditions
                                          ↓
           Pay Code or approved presentation represents the authorized instruction
                                          ↓
                        Execution coordinates the approved outcome
                                          ↓
                      Evidence, state resolution, and reconciliation
```

Governing Distinctions

- A Funding Event records an external event; it does not appropriate, authorize, or manufacture public funds.
- Treasury represents operational state; it is not the government account, bank account, appropriation record, trust record, or general ledger.
- Settlement Resources retain their applicable legal, public, custody, and accounting character outside the operational grammar.
- A Lien reserves capacity; it does not transfer custody.
- A Facility carries service and approved commercial meaning; a Pay Code does not.
- The governing government program remains the source of public purpose and authority; a Facility does not replace it.
- A Settlement Envelope carries conditions and evidence; it does not perform settlement.
- A Pay Code is a credential; it is not money, a benefit, or the service itself.
- A voucher may present an approved instruction; it does not create a separate balance or execution model.
- Execution coordinates the authorized outcome through the institution's approved capability.
- Reconciliation compares operating state with public, banking, and provider evidence and resolves differences through approved procedures.

Throughout this progression, the underlying funds remain within applicable government and regulated banking relationships. The grammar makes operating state visible; it does not change custody or public authority.

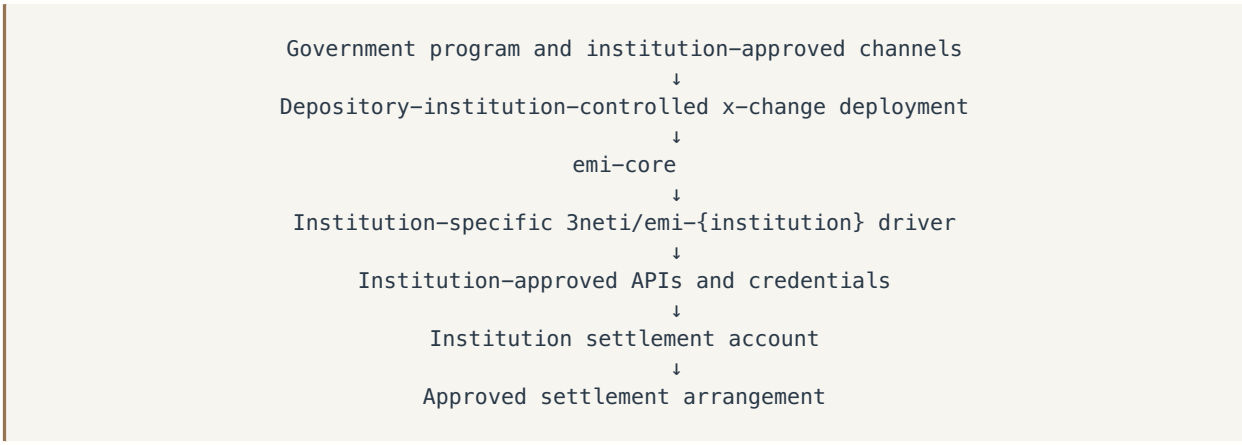
See Canonical Diagrams for the governed visual forms.

APPENDIX E

Deployment Architecture

Deployment architecture defines where institutional control remains and where providers may act under delegated authority. The governing question is not simply where the software runs. It is whether the institution retains control over its environment, data, credentials, providers, releases, evidence, and production decisions.

This appendix explains those responsibility boundaries. It is not an infrastructure specification, security design, public authority, procurement instrument, or production authorization.



Institution-Controlled Boundary

The depository institution owns or controls the approved production boundary. That control includes its hosting account, domains, deployment, databases, institutional data, encryption and access configuration, production credentials, provider accounts, monitoring, logs, backups, recovery, release approvals, and audit trail.

A managed-service provider may operate components only under delegated authority. Delegation changes who performs the work; it does not transfer institutional ownership or production accountability.

Separate institution deployments remain the default. Common licensed software does not require shared application tenancy, databases, credentials, government records, customer records, production authority, or audit trails.

Maintained Software Boundary

ODTI maintains x-change, `emi-core`, supported components, documentation, reference architecture, and testing capability within agreed scope. The institution-specific driver is discovered, implemented, certified, and maintained under its approved scope.

Maintenance does not create pooled funds, common credentials, shared customer or beneficiary balances, or a common institutional operation.

Integration Boundary

`3neti/emi-{institution}` implements the common contract for the institution's approved API behavior. Credentials and environment configuration remain separate from maintained source packages. Changes to authentication, certificates, endpoints, messages, statuses, reconciliation evidence, or API versions remain subject to institutional change governance.

Government-System Boundary

Government portals, program systems, participant records, approvals, accounting systems, and reporting platforms remain under the authority of the responsible public institution. Integration must preserve that boundary across data minimization, identity, access, records, correction, support, and reconciliation. x-change does not become the source of public authority.

Settlement Boundary

The depository institution owns or establishes the settlement account, participation, provider relationship, limits, credentials, and execution authority. No exclusive settlement institution is presumed. Shared settlement infrastructure does not require shared software tenancy.

Production Boundary

Driver certification, provider certification, and successful demonstration provide evidence. They do not authorize production. Production requires the applicable public, banking, legal, risk, security, operational, accounting, reconciliation, continuity, and governance decisions.

The supporting Program Architecture explains ownership, licensing, operational, settlement, and infrastructure boundaries in full.

APPENDIX F

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the Program?

It is the institution-specific initiative through which an eligible government depository institution establishes a reusable governed operating Capability for selected public-finance services. It combines maintained software, institution-specific integration, controlled deployment, public and banking governance, testing, evidence, and continuing support.

What does the Program authorize?

Nothing by itself. It does not confer government-depository authority, program eligibility, procurement preference, public funding, settlement access, or production approval. Those remain subject to applicable authority and institutional decision.

Why is settlement connectivity not enough?

A rail or API can move funds. It does not by itself establish public purpose, validate authority, recognize and reserve resources, apply conditions, manage exceptions, support participants, preserve evidence, or reconcile the complete obligation.

What does x-change do?

x-change coordinates governed public-finance banking ceremonies through a reusable operating grammar. It does not provide public or banking authority, appropriate funds, accept deposits, hold public money, create stored value, own institutional relationships, or become the settlement provider.

What does `emi-core` do?

`emi-core` defines the maintained common contract for preparing and submitting approved instructions, preserving references, receiving status, handling provider responses and ambiguity, and supporting reconciliation. It does not contain the public or commercial meaning of a Facility.

Why is an institution-specific driver necessary?

Institutional APIs differ in authentication, certificates, request formats, signatures, idempotency, webhooks, status models, limits, errors, reversals, reconciliation evidence, and versioning. `3neti/emi-{institution}` maps the common contract to one institution's approved behavior. It requires discovery, mapping, implementation, certification, and maintenance; it is not automatically available.

What is a Pay Code?

A Pay Code is a credential representing an authorized instruction. It can be communicated, presented, validated, and executed under the governing Facility and Settlement Envelope. It is not money, a benefit, a deposit, a voucher balance, or the banking service itself.

Can a government voucher contain a Pay Code?

Yes, when the responsible institutions approve the journey. A printed or digital voucher may carry or resolve to the credential. The voucher does not create a second Treasury, stored-value balance, or execution model.

Where do public funds remain?

They remain within the applicable government accounts, depository accounts, and regulated settlement arrangements. Their legal, custody, appropriation, trust, and accounting character is not determined by x-change Treasury state.

Does common software create a shared bank?

No. Each participating institution may retain its own deployment, data, credentials, release controls, provider accounts, settlement relationships, operating decisions, and audit trail. Shared software and settlement infrastructure do not require shared tenancy or shared institutional authority.

Who owns the government relationship?

The public entity retains its program and constituent relationships. The depository institution retains its banking, depositor, customer, and government relationships. ODTI and other providers acquire neither through the Program.

Who owns production?

The depository institution owns or controls its approved production environment and banking release decision. Production of a public workflow also depends on the approvals of the responsible public institution and other applicable authorities.

Is NetBank or another specific settlement provider required?

No. The Program presumes no exclusive settlement institution. The depository institution uses settlement arrangements it has established and approved.

What remains the depository institution's responsibility?

Banking authority, custody, accounts, policy, infrastructure approval, credentials, production decisions, operations, Treasury, security, risk, compliance, support, accounting, reconciliation, provider relationships, evidence, and institutional readiness remain its responsibilities within the applicable arrangement.

What remains the government entity's responsibility?

Public purpose, program authority, funding authority, participant basis, approvals, conditions, public records, reporting, and accountability remain with the responsible public institution within its mandate.

What does ODTI maintain?

ODTI maintains the licensed x-change software, `emi-core`, supported components, documentation, reference architecture, and testing capability within agreed scope. ODTI may perform or coordinate agreed driver work. It does not declare the institutions operationally ready.

When is the institution ready?

Readiness exists only when the responsible institutions judge that sufficient evidence supports lawful authorization, operation, supervision, security, settlement, reconciliation, support, records, audit, and governance. Driver certification is one technical input, not the readiness decision.

See the supporting Institution Intelligence Research Gate and Institution Readiness for the complete evidence and maturity model.

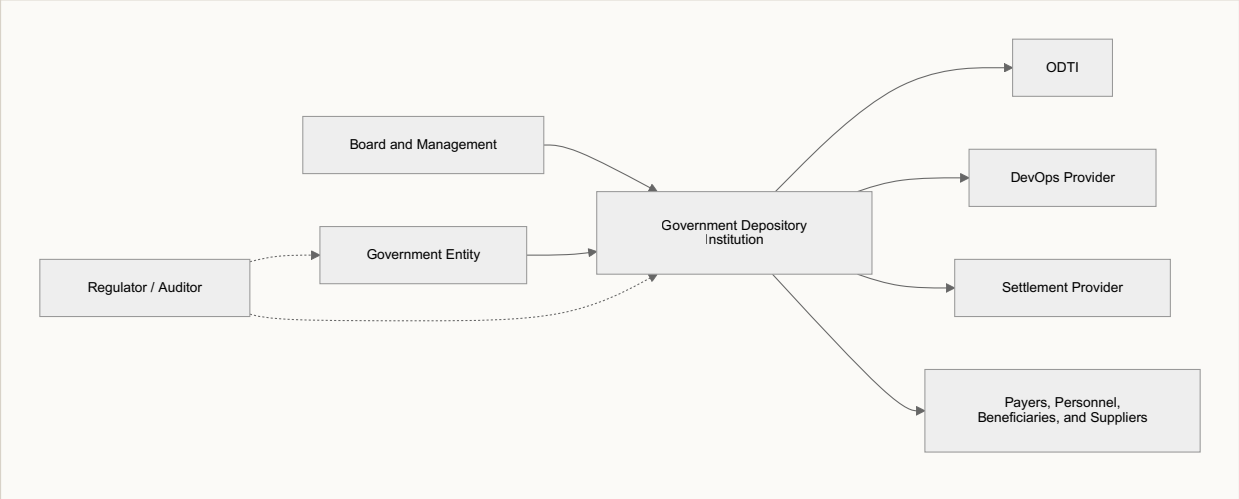
APPENDIX G

Canonical Diagrams

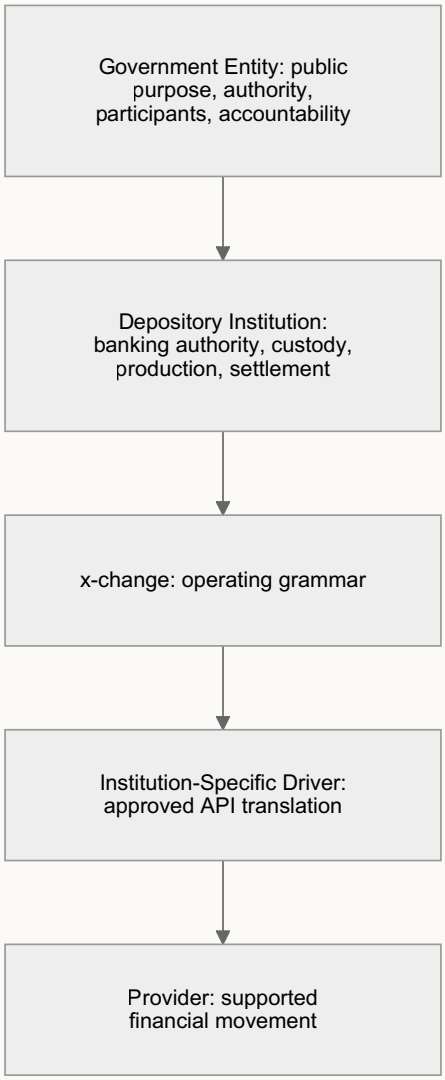
These governed figures show how responsibility and sequence remain separated throughout the Government Depository Program. They provide conceptual views for executive and implementation reference. They do not describe production topology, confer public authority, establish procurement status, or determine legal fund characterization.

The supporting Program Architecture, Stakeholder Architecture, and Government Workflow Taxonomy explain the institutional context represented in these figures.

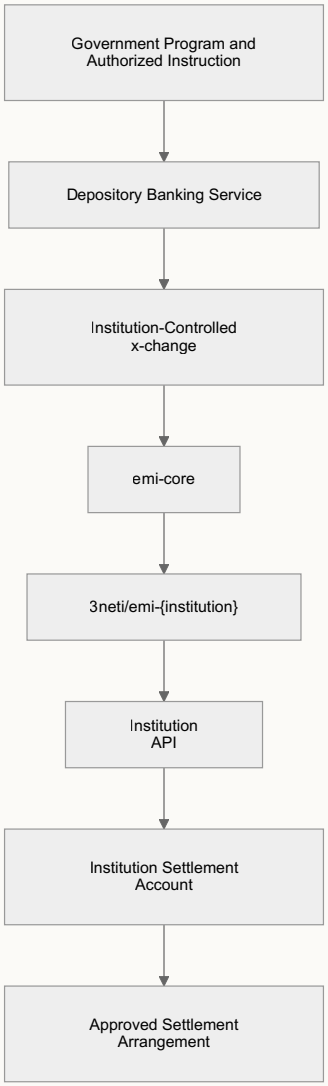
Program Participants



Institutional Boundaries



Banking Operating Model



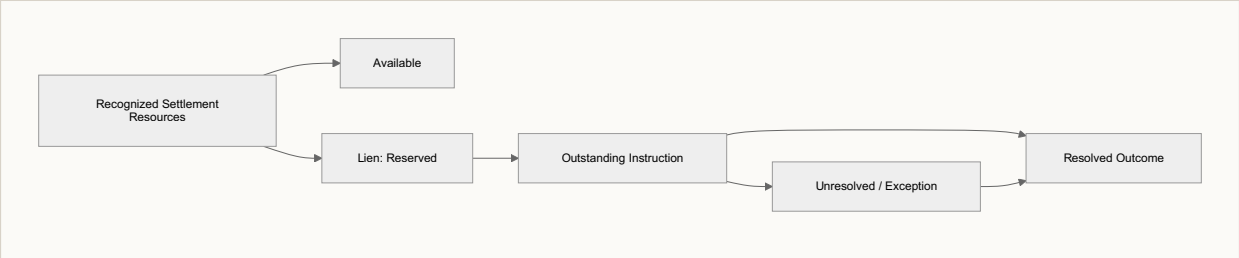
Operating Grammar



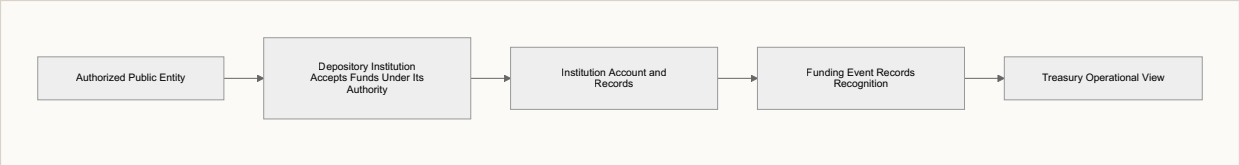
Funding Event



Treasury



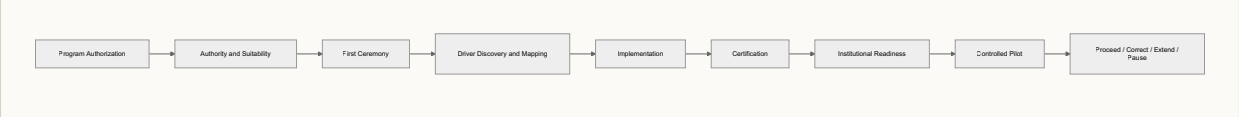
Deposit Flow



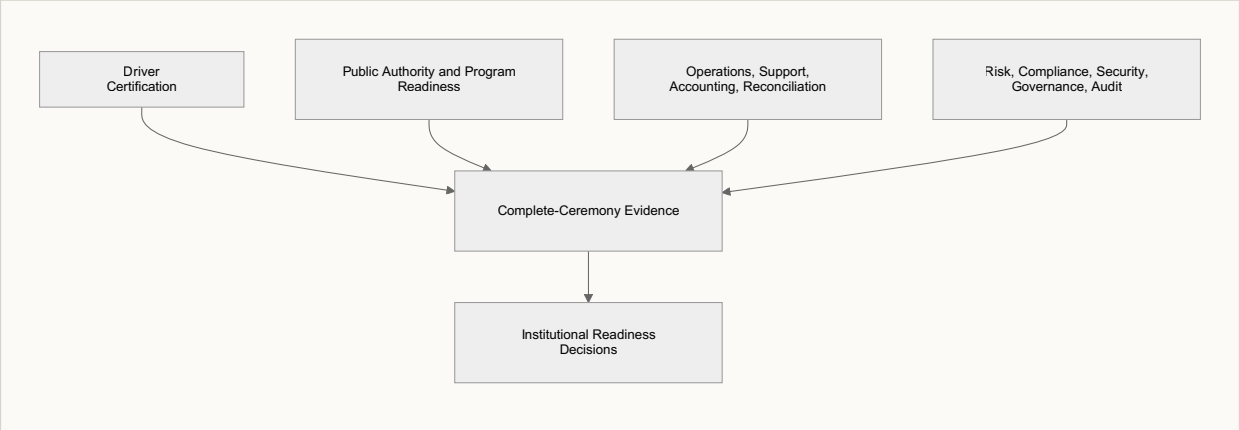
Driver Architecture



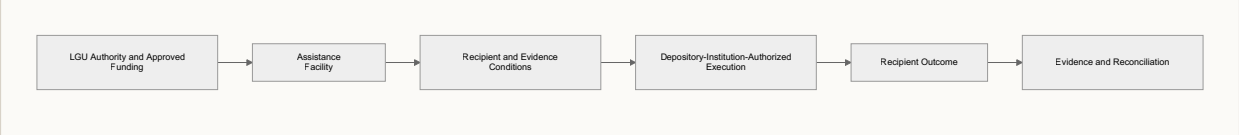
Program Lifecycle



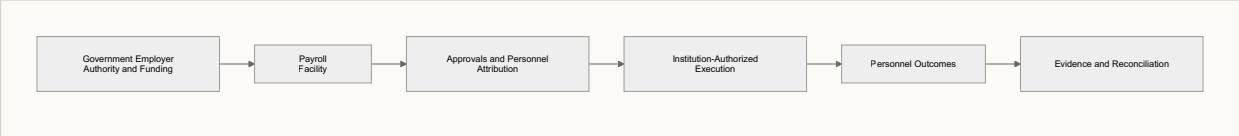
Readiness



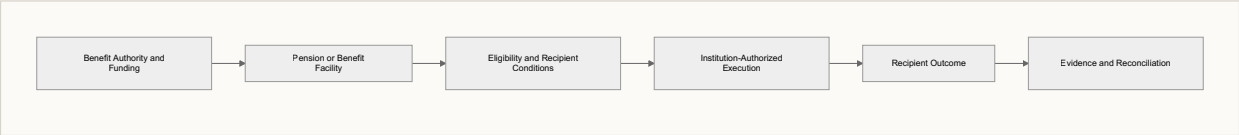
LGU Assistance Flow



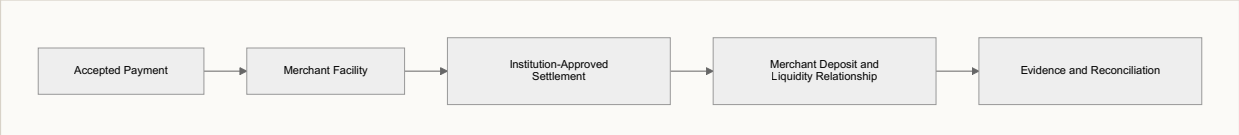
Payroll Flow



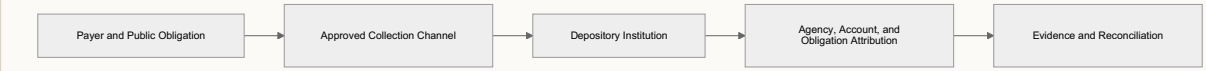
Pension and Benefit Flow



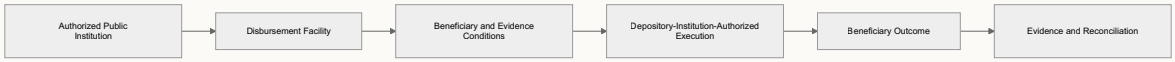
Merchant Flow



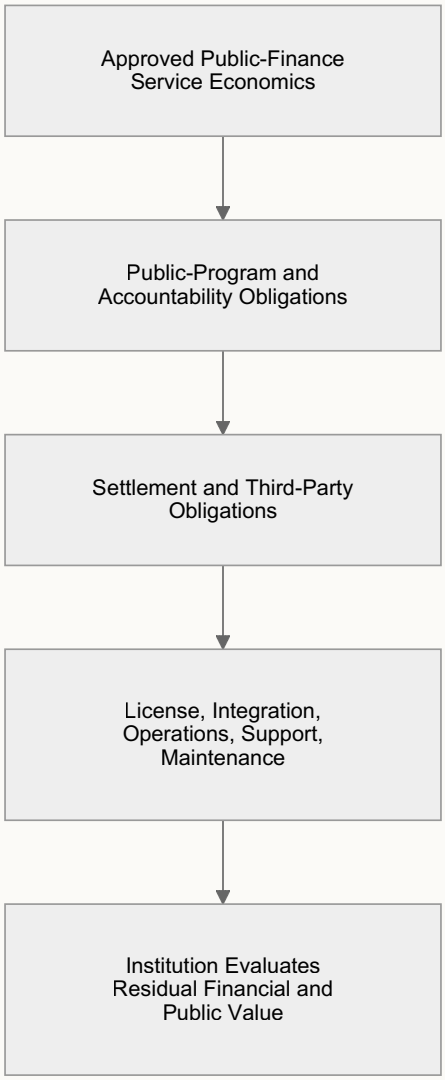
Government Collection Flow



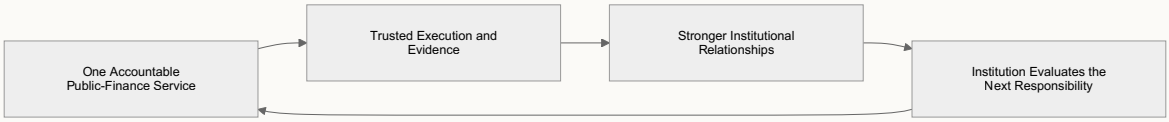
Government Disbursement Flow



Commercial Waterfall



Public-Finance Relationship Expansion



Deployment Architecture

